

— DAD'S CODE · HIGH-PROTEIN MEAL GUIDE



DAD FUEL

High-protein meals for the tired dad who needs to keep going.

Dad's Code by Jamie Wigg · *Present, not perfect.*

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40 meal options. 15 full recipe cards, a 1-hour prep system, and 25 grab-and-go ideas.

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Jamie's voice

I know what running on empty feels like. For years I was overweight, exhausted and anxious — dragging myself through the day on toast and coffee.

Rebuilding my health changed everything, and the biggest lever wasn't some miracle. It was simple: **eat enough protein, keep it easy, and stop running on fumes.**

These are the meals that fuel a tired dad. No chef skills, no fancy gear, no weighing your food. Just real food that keeps you going so you can show up for the people who need you.

— *Present, not perfect.*

⚠ READ THIS FIRST

This guide is general information only — not medical, dietary or nutrition advice, and not a substitute for care from a qualified professional.

- ! The protein guidance here is **general and non-prescriptive**. It is not a personalised plan and does not set targets for any individual.
- ! If you've had **bariatric or weight-loss surgery**, are managing a **medical condition**, take **medication**, are **pregnant**, or have **food allergies or intolerances**, follow **your own dietitian's or doctor's plan first**. Portion sizes, textures and protein needs after surgery are individual — your care team's advice always overrides anything in this book.
- ! Recipes contain common allergens (eggs, dairy, fish, nuts, gluten, soy). **Check every ingredient against your own needs** and adjust or skip as required.
- ! If anything here conflicts with professional advice you've been given, **ignore this guide and follow the professional**.
- ! Eat to feel well. If something doesn't sit right with you, stop and check with your GP or dietitian.

THE ONE RULE

AIM FOR A **PALM-SIZED SERVE OF PROTEIN** AT EVERY MEAL — EGGS, MEAT, FISH, DAIRY, BEANS, TOFU.

Protein helps you feel full, keeps your energy steadier, and protects muscle while you move more. That's about 90% of the job. Get that right most days and the rest takes care of itself. *(General guide only — see Read This First.)*

04 · HOW TO READ THE CARDS

Every card, **built the same**

So you can scan it in seconds.



Time

How long, start to plate.



Serves

How many it makes.



Protein Badge

A rough per-serve protein estimate in grams (amber circle). Estimates only — values vary with brands and portions.



Ingredients

Short shopping-style list.



Steps

Numbered, plain-spoken.



Fuel Tip

One quick win to make it easier, cheaper or higher-protein.

Look for the tags:

HIGH PROTEIN

PREPS/FREEZES WELL

UNDER 15 MIN



15-Min Fuel

7 RECIPES

Fast, minimal cook. For the days you've got minutes, not hours.

Greek Yogurt Power Bowl

HIGH PROTEIN

UNDER 15 MIN

5 min • Serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 1 big spoon Greek yogurt (about a cup)
- Handful of berries
- Handful of nuts
- Drizzle of honey

STEPS

- 1 Spoon yogurt into a bowl.
- 2 Top with berries and nuts.
- 3 Drizzle honey. Done.

Fuel Tip: Buy plain high-protein Greek yogurt and add your own honey — way more protein, way less sugar than the flavoured tubs.

Tuna & White Bean Salad

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

🕒 UNDER 15 MIN

~35g
PROTEIN

10 min · Serves 1–2

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- 1 tin tuna, drained
- 1 tin cannellini beans, drained
- 1 tomato, chopped
- Olive oil + lemon juice
- Salt and pepper

👣 STEPS

- 1 Tip tuna and beans into a bowl.
- 2 Add tomato.
- 3 Dress with oil, lemon, salt and pepper. Mix.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** No cooking, massive protein, keeps in the fridge. Make double for tomorrow's lunch.

Cottage Cheese Toast, 3 Ways

 HIGH PROTEIN

 UNDER 15 MIN

~20g
PROTEIN

5 min • Serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 2 slices wholegrain toast
- Cottage cheese
- Pick a topper: (a) tomato + pepper · (b) banana + honey · (c) egg + chilli

STEPS

- 1 Toast the bread.
- 2 Spread cottage cheese on thick.
- 3 Add your topper of choice.

 **Fuel Tip:** Cottage cheese is the most underrated protein hit going — cheap, filling, and it works sweet or savoury.

Post-Run Protein Smoothie

 HIGH PROTEIN

 UNDER 15 MIN

~30g
PROTEIN

3 min • Serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup milk
- 1 scoop protein powder
- 1 banana
- 1 spoon peanut butter
- Handful of oats

STEPS

- 1 Tip everything in a blender.
- 2 Blend until smooth.
- 3 Drink. Recovery in a cup.

 **Fuel Tip:** Freeze the banana first for a thick, milkshake-feel smoothie with zero ice needed.

Steak & Sweet Potato

 **HIGH PROTEIN**

 **UNDER 15 MIN**

~40g
PROTEIN

15 min • Serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 1 steak
- 1 sweet potato
- Handful of greens
- Oil, salt, pepper

STEPS

- 1 Microwave the sweet potato (8–10 min) while you heat the pan.
- 2 Pan-sear the steak to your liking; rest it a couple of minutes.
- 3 Steam or microwave the greens. Plate up.

 **Fuel Tip:** Proper dad fuel, fast. Resting the steak for 2 minutes makes it far juicier — don't skip it.

Mince & Egg Power Bowl

 **HIGH PROTEIN**

 **UNDER 15 MIN**

~38g
PROTEIN

12 min • Serves 1

INGREDIENTS

- 150g mince
- Splash of soy sauce + garlic
- 1 egg
- Cooked rice or greens to serve

STEPS

- 1 Brown the mince with garlic and a splash of soy.
- 2 Fry an egg.
- 3 Serve mince over rice or greens, top with the egg.

 **Fuel Tip:** Huge protein, dead simple. Use leftover rice from your Sunday prep and it's a 5-minute job.

Egg & Veg Scramble Wrap

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

🕒 UNDER 15 MIN

~22g
PROTEIN

8 min · Serves 1

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- 3 eggs
- Handful of spinach
- Cheese
- 1 wrap

👣 STEPS

- 1 Scramble the eggs with spinach.
- 2 Stir in cheese to melt.
- 3 Roll it all up in the wrap.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** Works for breakfast or a late-night refuel. Add leftover veg or mince to bulk it out.



Meal-Prep Heroes

8 RECIPES

Big-batch and freezes well. Cook once, eat all week.

Big-Batch Beef & Bean Chilli

 HIGH PROTEIN FREEZES WELL

~35g
PROTEIN

30 min • Serves 5

INGREDIENTS

- 500g lean beef mince
- 1 onion
- 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- 1 tin kidney beans
- Chilli + cumin

STEPS

- 1 Brown the mince with the onion.
- 2 Add tomatoes, beans, chilli and cumin.
- 3 Simmer 20 min.
- 4 Portion into containers — lunch sorted all week.

 **Fuel Tip:** Freezes brilliantly. Make a double batch and you've got dinners stocked for a fortnight.

Overnight Protein Oats

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

📦 PREPS WELL

~30g
PROTEIN

5 min (night before) · Serves 1

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup oats
- Milk
- Greek yogurt
- 1 scoop protein
- 1 banana

👣 STEPS

- 1 Mix everything in a jar.
- 2 Lid on, fridge overnight.
- 3 Grab and go in the morning.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** Steady morning energy, no sugar crash. Make 3 jars at once for a stress-free week of breakfasts.

Chicken & Rice Prep Boxes

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

📦 PREPS WELL

~38g
PROTEIN

30 min · Serves 4

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- 8 chicken thighs, seasoned
- 1½ cups rice
- 1 tray of veg

👣 STEPS

- 1 Bake the seasoned thighs.
- 2 Cook the rice.
- 3 Roast a tray of veg.
- 4 Box into four — four ready dinners.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** Thighs stay juicier than breast and cost less. Season three different ways so it doesn't feel like the same meal four nights running.

Freezer Breakfast Burritos

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

🧊 FREEZES WELL

~28g
PROTEIN

30 min • Serves 6

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- 6 eggs
- 250g mince
- Cheese
- 1 capsicum
- 6 tortillas

👣 STEPS

- 1 Scramble eggs with mince, cheese and capsicum.
- 2 Roll the filling into the tortillas.
- 3 Wrap and freeze.
- 4 Microwave 2 min on a rough morning.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** Wrap each one in foil or baking paper before freezing so they don't stick together.

Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs & Veg

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

🧊 PREPS WELL

~36g
PROTEIN

30 min • Serves 4

🛒 INGREDIENTS

- Chicken thighs
- Chopped veg
- Oil, salt, pepper

👣 STEPS

- 1 Spread thighs and veg on one tray.
- 2 Roast 25 min at 200°C.
- 3 Serve now; box the rest for lunch.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** One tray means one wash-up. Line it with baking paper and you've barely got that.

Lentil & Sausage One-Pot

 **FREEZES WELL**

~28g
PROTEIN

30 min • Serves 4

INGREDIENTS

- 4 good sausages
- 1 cup lentils
- 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- Stock

STEPS

- 1 Brown the sausages in the pot.
- 2 Add lentils, tomato and stock.
- 3 Simmer until thick.

 **Fuel Tip:** Hearty, cheap and it freezes well. The lentils bump the protein and keep you full for hours.

Salmon Traybake

 **HIGH PROTEIN**

~34g
PROTEIN

25 min • Serves 2

INGREDIENTS

- 2 salmon fillets
- Tray of veg
- Lemon + olive oil

STEPS

- 1 Lay salmon and veg on a tray.
- 2 Drizzle with lemon and oil.
- 3 Bake 18 min.

 **Fuel Tip:** Omega-3s plus protein for brain and body. Frozen salmon fillets are cheaper and just as good baked.

Big-Batch Chicken Soup

⚡ HIGH PROTEIN

🧊 FREEZES WELL

~30g
PROTEIN

30 min · Serves 6

INGREDIENTS

- Chicken (thighs or a small whole bird)
- Stock
- Veg
- Handful of pasta or rice

STEPS

- 1 Simmer chicken in stock with the veg.
- 2 Add pasta or rice near the end.
- 3 Cool and portion.

💡 **Fuel Tip:** Freezes for weeks — medicine on a hard day. Shred extra chicken into wraps or salads through the week.

07 · SECTION THREE



Grab & Go

Near-zero cook — for the days you've got nothing left in the tank.

Already in 15-Min Fuel: the Greek Yogurt Power Bowl, Tuna & White Bean Salad and Cottage Cheese Toast all double as grab-and-go.

The fastest wins from the 25-idea list below:

Boiled eggs + cheese Tuna on crackers A protein shake Chicken + hummus wrap Turkey & cheese roll-ups Cold chicken + avocado Yogurt + protein granola

The 1-Hour Sunday Prep

In about 60 minutes you can set up your whole week — so tired-you doesn't have to decide anything.

THE FLOW

1

Bake

A tray of chicken +
a tray of veg.

2

Cook

A pot of rice + a
batch of chilli or
soup.

3

Boil

6 eggs.

4

Box

Into 4–5 lunches /
dinner.



SUNDAY PREP CHECKLIST



Chicken tray in the oven



Veg tray in the oven



Rice on the stove



Chilli or soup simmering



6 eggs boiling



Containers out and labelled



Everything boxed and in the fridge



System Tip: Do it while the kids are busy or the game's on. One hour now buys you

25 More High-Protein Ideas

15 recipes + these 25 = 40 meal options.

01 Boiled eggs + cheese

02 Greek yogurt + nuts

03 Tuna on crackers

04 Protein shake

05 Beef jerky + fruit

06 Chicken + hummus wrap

07 Cottage cheese + pineapple

08 Edamame

09 Turkey & cheese roll-ups

10 Baked beans + egg

11 Prawn stir-fry

12 Lentil dahl

13 Ham & egg cups

14 Salmon & rice

15 Chickpea curry

16 Steak salad

17 Protein pancakes

18 Feta & tomato omelette

19 Cold chicken + avocado

20 Milk + banana

21 Sardines on toast

22 Bean burrito bowl

23 Roast beef wrap

24 Scrambled tofu

25 Yogurt + protein granola

YOU CAN'T POUR FROM AN **EMPTY CUP** — AND YOUR KIDS NEED YOU RUNNING ON MORE THAN COFFEE AND STRESS.

Fuel yourself like you matter. Because you do. Start with one meal
this week — then let it become the way you eat.

HEAR THE STORY

The Dad's Code Podcast

The honest version of how I rebuilt
my health, energy and head — the
conversations behind this guide.

Listen to Dad's Code →

COOK ALONG

Dad's Code Kitchen

The companion: more high-protein
recipes, prep videos and shopping
lists to keep your week sorted.

Join the Kitchen →

— *Present, not perfect.*

Dad's Code

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